12-Session Skills Group

Interpersonal Effectiveness

Supplemental Reading

Overview: Building Relationships and Ending Destructive Ones

FINDING AND GETTING PEOPLE TO LIKE YOU

Proximity, similarity, conversation skills, expressing liking, and joining groups

ENDING DESTRUCTIVE/ INTERFERING RELATIONSHIPS

Staying in WISE MIND

Using skills

Staying safe

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(Interpersonal Effectiveness Worksheet 8)

Finding and Getting People to Like You

REMEMBER: ALL HUMAN BEINGS ARE LOVABLE.

But finding friends may take effort on your part.

LOOK FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE CLOSE BY YOU.

Familiarity often leads to liking and sometimes love.

To find people you might like and who might like you, it is important to make sure that you are frequently around and visible to a group of people. Many people find friends who are classmates or members of groups they join, or who work at or go to the same places.

LOOK FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE SIMILAR TO YOU.

We often make friends with people who share our interests and attitudes.

Though always agreeing with someone will not make you more attractive to them, a lot of people are attracted to those who share the same important interests and attitudes, such as politics, lifestyle, morals.

WORK ON YOUR CONVERSATION SKILLS.

Ask and respond to questions; respond with a little more info than requested.

Make small talk; don't underestimate the value of chit-chat.

Self-disclose skillfully; keep your self-disclosure close to that of the other person.

Don't interrupt; don't start talking just fractionally before or after someone else.

Learn things to talk about: Watch others; read; increase your activities and experiences.

EXPRESS LIKING (SELECTIVELY).

We often like the people we think like us.

Express genuine liking for the other person. But don't try to suck up to the other person or grovel. Find things to compliment that are not super-obvious. Don't praise too much too often, and never use compliments to obtain favors.

(***continued on next page***)

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JOIN AN ONGOING GROUP CONVERSATION.

If we wait for people to approach us, we may never have friends.

Sometimes we must make the first move in finding friends. This often requires us to know how to tell if a group is open or closed, and then, when it is open, how to approach and join in the ongoing group.

FIGURE OUT IF A GROUP IS OPEN OR CLOSED.

In open groups new members are welcome.

In closed groups new members may not be welcome.

Open Groups

- Everyone is standing somewhat apart.
- Members occasionally glance around the room.
- There are gaps in the conversation.
- Members are talking about a topic of general interest.

Closed Groups

- Everyone is standing close together.
- Members attend exclusively to each other.
- There is a very animated conversation with few gaps.
- Members seem to be pairing off.

FIGURE OUT HOW TO JOIN AN OPEN GROUP CONVERSATION.

Ways of Joining an Open Group	Potential Outcomes
Move gradually closer to the group.	It may not be clear from the slowness of your approach that you want to join them; it might even look as though you were creeping up and trying to eavesdrop!
Offer to refill members' glasses/ serve them food.	That could be overdoing things a bit. What would you do if they refused more food/drinks? Would it be clear enough that you wanted to join the group?
Stand beside them and chip in on their conversation.	That might seem rude. They haven't invited you to join them, and anyway, what exactly are you going to say when you chip in?
Go up and introduce yourself.	Isn't that overly formal? Having introduced yourself, then what do you say? Will they introduce themselves to you? Wouldn't you interrupt the conversation?
Wait for a break in the conversation, stand beside a friendly-looking member of the group and say something like "Mind if I join you?"	**This makes your intention clear and doesn't seem rude or interrupt the conversation; group members can then choose whether to introduce themselves or not.**

Identifying Skills to Find People and Get Them to Like You

For each A and B pair, check the more effective responses.

- ❑ **1A.** Realize that good relationships depend on what you do.
- ❑ **1B.** Think of relationships in vague, abstract terms.

- ❑ **2A.** Expect people to beat a path to your door.
- ❑ **2B.** Create and make full use of opportunities to come into regular contact with others.

- ❑ **3A.** Mix with people who share your attitudes and interests.
- ❑ **3B.** Mix with people with whom you have little in common.

- ❑ **4A.** Mix with people who respond positively to you and to life generally.
- ❑ **4B.** Mix with cynics and pessimists.

- ❑ **5A.** Express your opinions and attitudes, so that others can recognize similarities with you.
- ❑ **5B.** Keep your opinions and attitudes to yourself.

- ❑ **6A.** Answer questions briefly, and seldom ask or return them.
- ❑ **6B.** Show interest in others by asking questions.

- ❑ **7A.** Stay out of conversations other people are having, so people know you're respectful.
- ❑ **7B.** Politely ask to join in conversations, so you can meet more people.

- ❑ **8A.** Say nothing or everything about yourself, regardless of what others reveal.
- ❑ **8B.** Disclose roughly the same amount of personal information to others as they disclose to you.

- ❑ **9A.** Keep good opinions of others to yourself.
- ❑ **9B.** If you like others, let them know.

- ❑ **10A.** Protect yourself, and comment only on good points that are obvious to anyone and everyone.
- ❑ **10B.** Don't express liking indiscriminately.

- ❑ **11A.** Rely on flattery to get what you want when you think it will work.
- ❑ **11B.** Don't use flattery to influence others.

- ❑ **12A.** Stand near a friendly-looking person in a new group, wait for a lull in the conversation, and then ask if it's OK for you to join the group.
- ❑ **12B.** Stand near a group of new people and make sure your comments or opinions are heard.

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INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS WORKSHEET 8

(Interpersonal Effectiveness Handout 11)

Finding and Getting People to Like You

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Fill out this sheet whenever you practice finding friends and whenever you have an opportunity to practice, even if you don't (or almost don't) do anything to practice. Write on another sheet if you need more room.

List two ways you could (or do) make casual but regular contact with people.

1. _____
2. _____

List two ways you could find (or have found) people whose attitudes are similar to yours.

1. _____
2. _____

List two ways you could get in conversations (or have been in them) where you could ask a question, give an answer, give a compliment, or express liking to others.

1. _____
2. _____

List times you have been near a group conversation you could practice joining (or how you could find one).

1. _____
2. _____

Check the facts and be sure you have listed all of your opportunities to find potential friends. Add more ideas if necessary or ask your current friends or family for ideas.

Describe one thing you have done to make a new friend and get someone to like you.

_____

_____

Check off and describe each skill that you used.

____Proximity ____Similarity ____Conversation skills ____Expressed liking

_____

_____

Describe any efforts you made to join a conversational group. _____

_____

Describe any efforts you made to use your conversation skills with others. _____

_____

How effective was the interaction? _____

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(Interpersonal Effectiveness Worksheet 10)

Ending Relationships

A destructive relationship has the quality of destroying or completely spoiling either the quality of the relationship or aspects of yourself—such as your physical body and safety, your self-esteem or sense of integrity, your happiness or peace of mind, or your caring for the other person.

An interfering relationship is one that blocks or makes difficult your pursuing goals that are important to you; your ability to enjoy life and do things you like doing; your relationships with other persons; or the welfare of others that you love.

Decide to end relationships in WISE MIND,
NEVER in emotion mind.

If the relationship is IMPORTANT and NOT destructive,
and there is reason to hope it can be improved, try
PROBLEM SOLVING to repair a difficult relationship.

COPE AHEAD to troubleshoot
and practice ending the relationship ahead of time.

Be direct: Use the DEAR MAN GIVE FAST interpersonal
effectiveness skills.

Practice OPPOSITE ACTION FOR LOVE when you find
you love the wrong person.

PRACTICE SAFETY FIRST!
Before leaving a highly abusive or life-threatening
relationship, call a local domestic violence hotline or the
toll-free National Domestic Violence Hotline (1-800-799-7233)
for help with safety planning and a referral to a qualified
professional. See also the International Directory of Domestic
Violence Agencies (*www.hotpeachpages.net*).

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Identifying How to End Relationships

For each A and B pair, check the more effective response.

- ❑ **1a .** If a relationship is threatening your integrity or physical well-being, it is probably your fault, and you should see a therapist.
- ❑ **1B.** A relationship threatening your integrity or physical well-being is destructive, and you should consider getting out of it.

In the middle of an argument, you are so mad at the other person you don't want to have anything to do with this person any more.

- ❑ **5a .** You should end the relationship right then! You may forget all about how enraging the person is if you wait.
- ❑ **5B.** You should get out of emotion mind and into Wise Mind, and evaluate whether to stay or leave the relationship.

- ❑ **2a .** Relationships should be easy. If it's hard to have a relationship with someone, it's probably not worth it, and you should end it.
- ❑ **2B.** Most relationships need problem solving to work.

- ❑ **6a .** If ending a destructive relationship will be difficult, it's most effective to stay together.
- ❑ **6B.** If ending a destructive relationship will be difficult, it's most effective to cope ahead of time.

- ❑ **3a .** If you are in love with someone who does not love you back, practice DEAR MAN skills to get the person to love you.
- ❑ **3B.** If you are in love with someone who does not love you back, practice opposite action to love.

- ❑ **7a .** In an abusive relationship, if the person hits you, you should use your interpersonal skills to tell the person you are leaving the relationship.
- ❑ **7B.** In an abusive relationship, you should seek professional assistance to leave the relationship.

- ❑ **4a .** To decide whether to end a relationship, do PROS and CONS.
- ❑ **4B.** To decide whether to end a relationship, use GIVE skills.

- ❑ **8a .** If you feel consistently invalidated in a relationship, it is probably your fault.
- ❑ **8B.** If you are consistently invalidated, the relationship is likely destructive.

12-Session Skills Group

Skills To Dialectically Manage Your Addiction

Supplemental Reading

Overview: When the Crisis Is Addiction

Skills for backing down from addiction.
You can remember them as D, C, B, A.

D

- DIALECTICAL ABSTINENCE

C

- CLEAR MIND
- COMMUNITY REINFORCEMENT

B

- BURNING BRIDGES AND BUILDING NEW ONES

A

- ALTERNATE REBELLION
- ADAPTIVE DENIAL

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Common Addictions

In case you thought you had no addictions, here is a list.

You are *addicted* when you are unable to stop a behavior pattern or use of substances, despite negative consequences and despite your best efforts to stop.

- ❑ Alcohol
- ❑ Attention seeking
- ❑ Avoiding: _____
- ❑ Auto racing
- ❑ Betting
- ❑ Bulimia (purging/vomiting)
- ❑ Cheating
- ❑ Coffee
- ❑ Colas
- ❑ Collecting:
  - ❑ Art
  - ❑ Coins
  - ❑ Junk
  - ❑ Clothes
  - ❑ Shoes
  - ❑ Music
  - ❑ Other: _____
  - ❑ Other: _____
- ❑ Computers
- ❑ Criminal activities
- ❑ Dieting
- ❑ Drugs (illicit and prescribed)
- ❑ Diuretics
- ❑ E-mail
- ❑ Food/eating
  - ❑ Carbohydrates
  - ❑ Chocolate
  - ❑ Specific food: _____
- ❑ Gambling
- ❑ Games/puzzles
- ❑ Gossiping
- ❑ Imagining/fantasizing
- ❑ Internet
- ❑ Internet games
- ❑ Kleptomania/stealing/shoplifting
- ❑ Lying
- ❑ Pornography
- ❑ Reckless driving
- ❑ Risky behaviors
- ❑ Self-inflicted injury/self-mutilation
- ❑ Sex
- ❑ Shopping
- ❑ Sleeping
- ❑ Smartphone apps
- ❑ Smoking/tobacco
- ❑ Social networking
- ❑ Speed
- ❑ Spiritual practices
- ❑ Sports activities:
  - ❑ Biking
  - ❑ Body building
  - ❑ Hiking/rock climbing
  - ❑ Running
  - ❑ Weight lifting
  - ❑ Other: _____
  - ❑ Other: _____
- ❑ Television
- ❑ Texting
- ❑ Vandalism
- ❑ Videos
- ❑ Video games
- ❑ Working

- ❑ Other: _____
- ❑ Other: _____
- ❑ Other: _____

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Dialectical Abstinence

ABSTINENCE *(Swearing off addictive behavior)*	**vs.**	**HARM REDUCTION** *(Acknowledging there will be slips; minimizing the damage, but not demanding perfection)*
Pro: People who commit to abstinence stay off longer. **Con:** It takes longer for people to get back "on the wagon" once they fall off.		**Pro:** When a slip does happen, people can get back "on the wagon" faster. **Con:** People who commit to harm reduction relapse quicker.

SYNTHESIS **= DIALECTICAL ABSTINENCE**

The goal is not to engage in addictive behavior again—in other words, to achieve complete abstinence.

However, if there is a slip, the goal is to minimize harm and get back to abstinence as soon as possible.

Pros: It works!

Cons: It's work. You don't get a vacation.

(You're always either abstinent or working to get back to abstinence.)

An example of expecting the best and planning for the trouble spots: Olympic athletes must believe and behave as though they can win every race, even though they have lost before and will lose again.

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Planning for Dialectical Abstinence

Plan for Abstinence

- ❑ 1. Enjoy your success, but with a clear mind; plan for temptations to relapse.
- ❑ 2. Spend time or touch base with people who will reinforce you for abstinence.
- ❑ 3. Plan reinforcing activities to do instead of addictive behaviors.
- ❑ 4. Burn bridges: Avoid cues and high-risk situations for addictive behaviors.
- ❑ 5. Build new bridges: Develop images, smells, and mental activities (such as, urge surfing) to compete with information associated with craving.
- ❑ 6. Find alternative ways to rebel.
- ❑ 7. Publicly announce abstinence; deny any idea of lapsing to addiction.

Plan for Harm Reduction

- ❑ 1. Call your therapist, sponsor, or mentor for skills coaching.
- ❑ 2. Get in contact with other effective people who can help.
- ❑ 3. Get rid of temptations; surround yourself with cues for effective behaviors.
- ❑ 4. Review skills and handouts from DBT.
- ❑ 5. Opposite action (Emotion Regulation Handout 10) can be rehearsed to fight guilt and shame. If no other option works, go to an anonymous meeting of any sort and publicly report your lapse.
- ❑ 6. Building mastery and coping ahead for emotional situations (Emotion Regulation Handout 19), and checking the facts (Emotion Regulation Handout 8), can be used to fight feelings of being out of control.
- ❑ 7. Interpersonal skills (Interpersonal Effectiveness Handouts 5–7), such as asking for help from family, friends, sponsors, ministers, or counselors, can also be helpful. If you are isolated, help can often be found via online support groups.
- ❑ 8. Conduct a chain analysis to analyze what prompted the lapse (General Handouts 7, 7a).
- ❑ 9. Problem-solve right away to find a way to “get back on the wagon” and repair any damage you have done (Emotion Regulation Handout 12).
- ❑ 10. Distract yourself, self-soothe, and improve the moment.
- ❑ 11. Cheerlead yourself.
- ❑ 12. Do pros and cons of stopping addictive behaviors (Distress Tolerance Handout 5).
- ❑ 13. Stay away from extreme thinking. Don’t let one slip turn into a disaster.
- ❑ 14. Recommit to 100% total abstinence.

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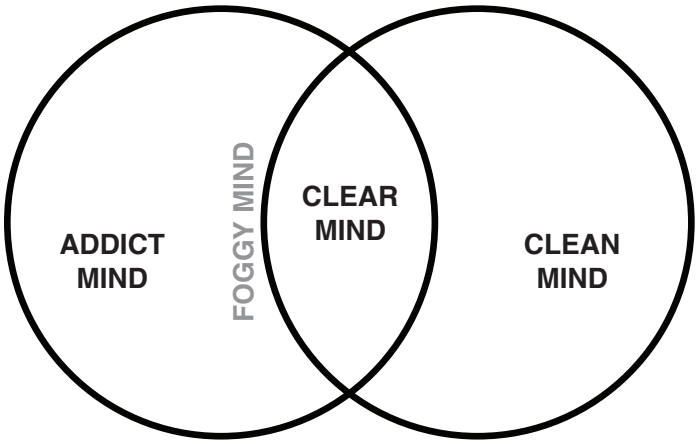
Clear Mind



Addict mind is:

Impulsive

One-minded

Willing to do anything for a "fix"

When in ***addict mind,*** you are ruled by the addiction. The urges for habitual problem behaviors determine your thoughts, emotions, and behaviors.

Clean mind is:

Naive

Risk-taking

Oblivious to dangers

When in ***clean mind,*** you are clean but oblivious to dangers that might cue habitual problem behaviors. You believe you are invincible and immune to future temptation.

Both extremes are *DANGEROUS*!

CLEAR MIND: The safest place to be.

You are clean, but you remember addict mind.

You radically accept that relapse is ***not impossible.***

You enjoy your ***success,*** while still ***expecting urges and cues*** and ***planning*** for when you're tempted.

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Behavior Patterns Characteristic of Addict Mind and of Clean Mind

ADDICT MIND

- ☐ Engaging in addictive behavior.
- ☐ Thinking, "I don't really have a problem with addiction."
- ☐ Thinking, "I can do a little."
- ☐ Thinking, "I can indulge my habit, if only on weekends."
- ☐ Thinking, "I can't stand this!"
- ☐ Glamorizing addiction.
- ☐ Surfing the Internet for ways to engage in addictive behaviors.
- ☐ Buying paraphernalia (food, drugs, videos, etc.) for addictive behavior.
- ☐ Selling or exchanging items related to addictive behaviors.
- ☐ Stealing to pay for addiction.
- ☐ Prostituting for money or for paraphernalia.
- ☐ Lying.
- ☐ Hiding.
- ☐ Isolating.
- ☐ Acting always busy; "Got to go!"
- ☐ Breaking promises.
- ☐ Committing crimes.
- ☐ Acting like a corpse.
- ☐ Having "no life."
- ☐ Acting desperate/obsessed.
- ☐ Not looking people in the eyes.
- ☐ Having poor hygiene.
- ☐ Avoiding doctors.
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

CLEAN MIND

- ☐ Engaging in **apparently irrelevant behaviors** that in the past inevitably led to addictive behavior.
- ☐ Thinking, "I've learned my lesson."
- ☐ Thinking, "I can control the habit."
- ☐ Thinking, "I don't really have an addiction problem any more."
- ☐ Stopping or cutting back medication that helps with addiction.
- ☐ Being in environments where others engage in addictive behaviors.
- ☐ Seeing friends who are still addicted.
- ☐ Living with people who are addicted.
- ☐ Keeping addiction paraphernalia.
- ☐ Carrying around extra money.
- ☐ Being irresponsible with bills.
- ☐ Dressing like an addict.
- ☐ Not going to meetings.
- ☐ Not confronting the problems that fuel my addictive behaviors.
- ☐ Acting as if only willpower is needed.
- ☐ Isolating.
- ☐ Believing, "I can do this alone."
- ☐ Thinking, "I can take pain medicine/diet/ engage in addictive behavior if prescribed or advised; I don't need to say anything about my past addiction."
- ☐ Thinking, "I can't stand this!"
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

Community Reinforcement

Community reinforcement means replacing addiction reinforcers with abstinence reinforcers.

REINFORCING ABSTINENCE IS CRITICAL

Reinforcers in your environment play a powerful role in encouraging or discouraging addictive behaviors.

To stop addictive behavior, you have to figure out how to make a lifestyle *without* your addictive behaviors more rewarding than a lifestyle *with* your addictive behaviors.

You have to find a way to get behaviors incompatible with addictions to pay off and be rewarded by those around you.

Willpower is *not* sufficient. If it were, we would all be perfect!

REPLACE ADDICTION REINFORCERS WITH ABSTINENCE REINFORCERS

Begin a series of action steps that will increase your chances of accumulating positive events to replace addictive behavior.

- ❑ Search for people to spend time with who aren't addicted.
- ❑ Increase the number of enjoyable activities you engage in that do not involve your addiction.
- ❑ If you cannot decide what people or activities you like, sample a lot of different groups of people and a lot of different activities.

ABSTINENCE SAMPLING

- ❑ Commit to ____ days off your addiction, and observe the benefits that naturally occur.
- ❑ Temporarily avoid high-risk addiction triggers, and replace these with competing behaviors to get you through the sampling period.
- ❑ Observe all the extra positive events occurring when you are not engaging in addictive behaviors.

Note. Adapted from Meyers, R. J., & Squires, D. D. (2001, September). *The community reinforcement approach.* Retrieved from *www.bhrm.org/guidelines/CRAmanual.pdf.* Adapted by permission of the authors.

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Burning Bridges and Building New Ones

BURNING BRIDGES

Accept at the most radical level that you are not going to engage in addictive behavior again, and then move actively to cut off all addictive behavior options.

- ❑ **1.** Make an absolute commitment to abstinence from the addictive behavior, which is _____ (describe addictive behavior). Then walk into the garage of abstinence and **slam the garage door shut.** (Remember that the tiniest slit of space can let an entire elephant in.)
- ❑ **2.** List everything in your life that makes addiction possible.
- ❑ **3.** Get rid of these things:
  - ❑ Throw out contact information of people who collude with you.
  - ❑ Get rid of all possible cues and temptations.
- ❑ **4.** List and do everything you can that will make it hard or impossible to continue your addictive behavior.
  - ❑ Ruthlessly and at every moment, tell the truth about your behavior.
  - ❑ Tell all your friends and family that you have **quit.**

BUILDING NEW BRIDGES

Create visual images and smells that will compete with the information loaded into your visual and olfactory brain systems when cravings occur.

Cravings and urges are strongly related to vivid images and smells of what is craved. The stronger the imagery or smell, the stronger the craving.

- ❑ Build different images or smells to think about. Try to keep these images or smells in memory when you have an unwanted craving. For example, whenever you crave a cigarette, imagine being on the beach; see and smell it in your mind to reduce the craving.
- ❑ When you have unwanted cravings, look at moving images or surround yourself with smells unrelated to the addiction. Moving images and new smells will compete with your cravings.
- ❑ "Urge-surf" by imagining yourself on a surfboard riding the waves of your urges. Notice them coming and going, rising high, going low, and finally going away.

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Alternate Rebellion and Adaptive Denial

ALTERNATE REBELLION

When addictive behaviors are a way to rebel against authority, conventions, and the boredom of not breaking rules or laws, try alternate rebellion. Alternate rebellion replaces destructive rebellion and keeps you on a path to your goals.

Examples:

- ❑ Shave your head.
- ❑ Wear crazy underwear.
- ❑ Wear unmatched shoes.
- ❑ Have secret thoughts.
- ❑ Express unpopular views.
- ❑ Do random acts of kindness.
- ❑ Vacation with your family at a nudist colony.
- ❑ Write a letter saying exactly what you want to.
- ❑ Dye your hair a wild color.
- ❑ Get a tattoo or body piercing.
- ❑ Wear clothes inside out.
- ❑ Don't bathe for a week.
- ❑ Print a slogan on a t-shirt.
- ❑ Paint your face.
- ❑ Dress up or dress down where doing so is unexpected.

ADAPTIVE DENIAL

When your mind can't tolerate craving for addictive behaviors, try adaptive denial.

- ❑ Give logic a break when you are doing this. Don't argue with yourself.
- ❑ When urges hit, deny that you want the problem behavior or substance. Convince yourself you want something other than the problem behavior. For example, reframe an urge to have a cigarette as an urge to have a flavored toothpick; an urge to have alcohol as an urge to have something sweet; or an urge to gamble as an urge to alternate rebellion (see above).

  Other: _____

  Other: _____

  Be adamant with yourself in your denial, and engage in the alternative behavior.
- ❑ Put off addictive behavior. Put it off for 5 minutes, then put it off for another 5 minutes, and so on and on, each time saying, "I only have to stand this for 5 minutes." By telling yourself each day you will be abstinent for today (or each hour for just this hour, and so on), you are saying, "This is not forever. I can stand this right now."

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Skills When the Crisis Is Addiction

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

Check off two skills for backing down from addiction to practice this week during a stressful situation:

- ☐ Plan for abstinence
- ☐ Plan for harm reduction
- ☐ Practice clear mind
- ☐ Search for abstinence reinforcers
- ☐ Increase non-addicting pleasant events

Sample abstinence for_____days
Burn bridges
Build new bridges
Practice alternate rebellion
Practice adaptive denial

Skill 1. Describe the situation and how you practiced the skill:

_____

_____

How effective was the skill in helping you cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse)? Circle a number below.

I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.		*I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.*		*I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.*
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**

Did this skill help you cope with uncomfortable emotions or urges, *or* avoid conflict of any kind? Circle YES or NO.

Describe how the skill helped or did not help: _____

_____

Skill 2. Describe the situation and how you practiced the skill:

_____

_____

How effective was the skill in helping you cope with the situation (keeping you from doing something to make the situation worse)? Circle a number below.

I still couldn't stand the situation, even for one more minute.		*I was able to cope somewhat, at least for a little while. It helped somewhat.*		*I could use skills, tolerated distress, and resisted problem urges.*
1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**

Did this skill help you cope with uncomfortable emotions or urges, *or* avoid conflict of any kind? Circle YES or NO.

Describe how the skill helped or did not help: _____

_____

Planning for Dialectical Abstinence

Due Date:_____ Name:_____Week Starting: _____

Problem Behavior: _____

Check each activity and describe what you did.

Plan for Abstinence

To maximize the chances I'll stop_____, I need to aim for abstinence.

☐ Plan activities to do instead of problem behaviors (e.g., work, find a hobby, go to a support meeting, volunteer). These will include:

_____

_____

☐ Spend time or touch base with people who will reinforce my *not* engaging in problem behaviors and my engaging in effective behaviors (e.g., effective friends or family members, co-workers, employers, my therapist, people from group). These people include:

_____

_____

☐ Remind myself of reasons to stay abstinent and be effective (e.g., to reach long-term goals, to keep/get relationship, to save money, to avoid shame). These include:

_____

_____

_____

☐ Burn bridges with people who represent a temptation (e.g., lose their numbers, unfriend them, tell them to stop contacting me, make them not want to hang out with me). These people include:

_____

_____

☐ Avoid cues for problem behaviors. Cues include:

_____

_____

_____

(***continued on next page***)

☐ Use skills (things to do to avoid urges, interpersonal effectiveness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation, mindfulness). The most useful skills for me include:

_____

_____

_____

☐ Find alternative ways to rebel. These include:

_____

_____

_____

❑ Publicly announce I've embraced abstinence and effective behavior.

Plan for Harm Reduction

If I have a slip, I don't want the slip to turn into a slide. To avoid a slide, I must have plans to regain my balance and get back to abstinence and effectiveness.

☐ Call my therapist, sponsor, or mentor for skills coaching. His or her numberis: _____

☐ Get in contact with other effective people who can help (e.g., friends or family, people from group). These people include(with contact information):

_____

_____

☐ Get rid of the temptations (e.g., drugs, comfort food); surround myself with cues for effective behaviors (e.g., workout clothes, fruit).

☐ Review skills and handouts from DBT. The most helpful skills/handouts for me are:

_____

_____

☐ Opposite action (Emotion Regulation Handout 10) can be rehearsed to fight guilt and shame. If no other option works, go to an anonymous meeting of any sort and publicly report your lapse.

☐ Building mastery and coping ahead for emotional situations (Emotion Regulation Handout 19), and checking the facts (Emotion Regulation Handout 8), can be used to fight feelings of being out of control.

(***continued on next page***)

❑ Interpersonal skills (Interpersonal Effectiveness Handouts 5–7), such as asking for help from family, friends, sponsors, ministers, or counselors, can also be helpful. If you are isolated, help can often be found via online support groups. These people or groups include:

_____

_____

☐ Conduct a chain analysis to analyze what prompted the lapse (General Handouts 7, 7a).

❑ Problem-solve right away to find a way to "get back on the wagon" and repair any damage you have done (Emotion Regulation Handout 12).

☐ Distract yourself, self-soothe, and improve the moment.

❑ Cheerlead myself (e.g., "One slip is not a disaster," "Don't give up," "Don't get willful," "I can still climb back on the wagon.") My cheerleading statements will include:

_____

_____

☐ Do pros and cons of stopping again *now*.

❑ Stay away from extreme thinking. Always look for the middle ground. Don't let one slip turn into a disaster. (Check each extreme thought I am giving up and the middle ground I am accepting.)

Extreme thinking:	Middle ground:
❑ I have not quit yet; therefore I am doomed and might as well give up.	❑ Relapsing once does not doom me to never stopping.
❑ Now that I've relapsed, I might as well keep going.	❑ I relapsed, but that does not mean I have to stay relapsed. I can be effective and get up now.
❑ I missed an appointment, so I'm done with treatment.	❑ I missed an appointment, but I can get in to see my therapist ASAP.
❑ Other:	❑ Other:
❑ Other:	❑ Other:

☐ Recommit to 100% total abstinence.

From Clean Mind to Clear Mind

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off each **clean mind** behavior you plan on changing this week. During the week, write down the **clear mind** behavior you did to replace **clean mind.**

CLEAN MIND BEHAVIORS	CLEAR MIND BEHAVIORS AS REPLACEMENTS
❑ **1.** Engaging in **apparently irrelevant** behaviors that in the past inevitably led to problem behavior.	_____
❑ **2.** Thinking, "I've learned my lesson."	_____
❑ **3. Believing, "I can control my addiction."**	_____
❑ **4. Thinking, "I don't really have an addiction."**	_____
❑ **5.** Stopping or cutting back medication that helps with addiction.	_____
❑ **6.** Being in addiction environments.	_____
❑ **7.** Seeing friends who are still addicted.	_____
❑ **8.** Living with people who are addicted.	_____
❑ **9.** Keeping addiction paraphernalia.	_____
❑ **10.** Carrying around extra money.	_____
❑ **11.** Being irresponsible with bills.	_____
❑ **12.** Dressing like an addict.	_____
❑ **13.** Not going to meetings.	_____
❑ **14.** Isolating.	_____
❑ **15.** Believing, "I can do this alone."	_____
❑ **16.** Ignoring problems fueling addiction.	_____
❑ **17.** Acting as if I only need willpower.	_____
❑ **18.** Thinking, "I don't need to say anything about my addiction."	_____
❑ **19.** Thinking, "I can't stand this!"	_____
❑ **20.** Other: _____	_____
❑ **21.** Other: _____	_____

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Burning Bridges and Building New Ones

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Rate the strength of your slamming the door on your addiction, from 0 (no intention of quitting addictive behavior) to 100 (complete and absolute commitment): _____. Go into Wise Mind and rate your level of slamming the door again: _____.

List all the things in your life that make addiction possible. Check those you get rid of.

- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____

List *all* tempting people, websites, and other contact information you need to continue addictive behaviors. Check those you erase or otherwise get rid of.

- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____

List all the things that would make addiction impossible. Check those that you do.

- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____
- ❑ _____

Describe imagery you can use to help reduce cravings:

Check and describe each strategy you have used to battle addiction urges.

❑ Kept new imagery in mind when urges hit: _____

_____

❑ Looked at moving images: _____

❑ Surrounded self with new smells: _____

❑ Urge-surfed: _____

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